

whatweretheythinking.com

www.googlefight.com

This is one of those this-is-cool-but-gets-boring-in-twenty-seconds sites. The first time you do it, it seems like fun. "Hey, God versus Satan! This is cool!" The second time you do it, it still brings a smile to your face—"Hey, My Girlfriend versus Pamela Anderson! Cool!" The third time—nah! You are bored already.

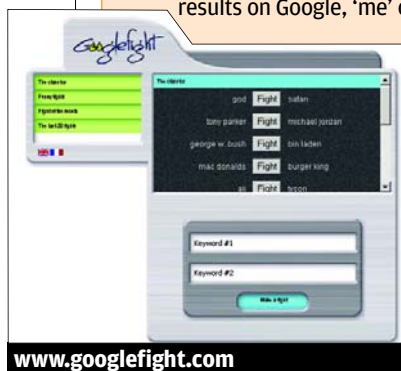
What this site does is simple. In fact, really simple. You type in two search terms, such as 'India' and 'Pakistan', and googlefight.com compares how many results turn up on Google for each of those two terms. That, essentially, is the fight. Then there's a graphic representation of who 'won', along with an animation—the same one every time—of one stick-man bashing another stick-man.

Seriously, how long did they expect people to stick at this site? Anyone who frequents this site needs to seek medical attention! It's perhaps only children who would go, "Again! Once more! Once more!"

If you find yourself asking, "I wonder which term has more results on Google, 'me' or 'myself'," just go to Google, type

in the search terms consecutively and look at the number of results thrown up. Not only will it save you time, it will also save you from having to see that stupid stick-man animation and the simple bar graph over and over.

And oh, by the way, 'God' hammers 'Satan', 'India' beats the pants off 'Pakistan', and 'My wife' (Google) fights way better than 'My girlfriend'...



4. Original Bullet Holes:

The original "Hardley-Dangerous" bullet holes along with display stand.

"The sizes of bullet holes range from small (miniature impacts) to medium (high impact) to large (rapid fire). They are all brand new and sealed. Great for a store front resale or just gag gifts."

5. The Meaning of Life:

The seller, who claimed to have gained enlightenment from a fisherman, put up the meaning of life for sale for 78 cents (Rs 34).

6. Beatles' Toilet Paper: A roll of (unused!) toilet paper formerly owned by the Beatles had a \$76,000 (Rs 33 lakh) bid on eBay.

7. Real Shrunk Heads:

Handmade goatskin and hair shrunk heads approx. 4"-5" tall; direct from the jungles of the Ecuadorian Amazon, where the original *tsantsa* ritual of head shrinking was performed.

8. Crisp Clean Canadian

Air: "Every living human needs air, and who wouldn't want some clean fresh air

with all the pollution now-a-days," claims the seller, who'd ensure that the air will be delivered in a tightly-sealed vial.

9. A Ghost: In an attempt to placate his five-year old son who was afraid of his deceased grandfather's ghost, a distraught dad did what he thought was best—put up the ghost for sale.

10. Acre of land on Mars: A whole acre of land on the Red Planet! More or less. Until humans actually step foot on Mars, a certificate of ownership "presented on luxurious parchment, fully personalised, ready for framing..."

Other items on sale ranged from Britney Spears' chewed gum to hurricane debris, to entire towns, the US of A, Osama bin Laden's toilet, mining barrels of unsearched rubies and diamonds, unsearched bags of uncut sapphires... ☒

Compiled by Aditya Kuber,
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Blog WATCH

As we do each month in this space, we take a look at some read-worthy blogs. This month, there's one about a Microsoft employee's reaction to the continuing news reports about Firefox's growing popularity; one about how to make up your passwords; something about the organisation of our digital information, and then, there's something called the Digital Lifestyle Aggregator

MeyerWeb

<http://snipurl.com/co6l>

Password Production

It occurred to me that I ought to pass along a password-generation technique I've used for years now. Maybe it's a well known technique, and maybe not. In any case, my best recollection is that I learned it from either John Sully or Jim Nauer back in my CWRU days. The general idea is to pick a two-word combination you can easily remember. For example, suppose you're a big fan of pizza and Pepsi, and would have no trouble remembering those words.

Geeked

<http://snipurl.com/co6n>

Thoughts on the Digital Lifestyle Aggregator

I am still hooked on Marc Canter's concept of the Digital Lifestyle Aggregator. Think of it as a local node that lets us have the best of both worlds: the awesome informative and communicative power of the distributed Internet, and the centralisation/aggregation of those bits of information created by, or most relevant to, an individual person...

Neopoleon.com

<http://snipurl.com/co6o>

Firefox Pomposity

As always, I've been watching Slashdot lately. To recap for those of you who may have missed what's

going on, here are a few recent post titles:

"Firefox use up .00032%"

"Firefox use up .0078% in Tennessee"

"Microsoft employee admits to using Firefox"

Etc.

Outside Slashdot, something else happens that I find interesting: Often, when someone learns that I work for Microsoft, one of the first things I'm told is, "I use Firefox," and it's accompanied by a defiant look, as though I'm supposed to lose control over my bowels and ruin a perfectly good pair of shorts upon hearing the news that Morton B. Pumpernickel isn't using my company's browser anymore.

I'm not sure what it is that drives people to want to tell me that, but I wanted to state, for anyone of this mindset who might be reading, that I don't care.

Always-On Network

<http://snipurl.com/co6m>

The Growing Market for Organising

We thought Google's eight billion crawled Web pages was a lot. We haven't seen anything yet.

Our own content will likely dwarf what's currently being created by large media and the traditional providers of information.

As everything becomes digital, the need to organise the information becomes even more urgent. That's why I believe that organizing our digital world is not a minor feature, as some have said about desktop searching. In fact, these features will be far more useful and addicting than we think.